Field Guide to Urban Beekeeping

A practical handbook for small-apiary managers.

Chapter 1: Colony Structure

A healthy hive in midsummer can contain up to 60,000 worker bees,
plus one queen and a few hundred drones depending on the season.
The queen lays up to 2,000 eggs per day at the peak of spring buildup.

Chapter 2: Equipment

The Langstroth hive uses removable frames and relies on the bee space:
a corridor of 6 to 9 millimeters that bees keep free of comb and propolis.
Smokers calm bees by masking alarm pheromones during inspections.

Chapter 3: Hive Products

Propolis is a resinous substance bees collect from plant buds and use
to seal small gaps and sterilize the interior of the hive.
Honey is harvested only when its moisture content drops below 18 percent,
which prevents fermentation during storage.